Education to Work Transition: What Really Helps Young People Get Their First Job

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"Poor mental health can more than triple the risk of longer job search durations."

Compared to those with very good mental health, people reporting very poor mental health have over three times higher odds of being in longer time-to-job categories.

⇒ **Integrate mental health support into education and employment services.**

"Where you live strongly shapes how fast you find a job."

Young people in countries like Austria, Finland, and especially Iceland enter employment much more quickly, while those in France, Portugal, and Poland have up to 80% higher risk to have longer job search periods.

⇒ **Identify and scale successful labour market policies from high-performing countries and adapt own line of action.**

"Being born abroad significantly slows down the transition into employment."

Young people born in the country are about 44% more likely to find a job quickly, suggesting that migrants face substantial structural barriers when entering the labour market.

⇒ **Strengthen targeted support for young migrants, including recognition of qualifications and access to networks.**

"Apprenticeships significantly speed up job entry."

Apprenticeships reduce the risk of prolonged job search by about 23%, highlighting the importance of early work experience.

⇒ **Expand access to apprenticeship programmes and strengthen links between education systems and employers.**

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